

Data Science Toolbox Portfolio Questions

03 Loss Minimisation for Decisions, Boosting, Forests

Daniel Lawson — University of Bristol

Block 3

Portfolio 03

Portfolio Question 3.1.P - Minimising Losses for Decision Trees

- How do we stop splitting a decision tree?
 - Compare information criteria and cross validation.
 - Can you find examples of when the choice matters?

Portfolio Question 3.2.P - Behind Boosting Trees

- How are the state-of-the-art boosting algorithms implemented?
- What is the intuition behind why boosting works?

Portfolio Question 3.3.P - The best classifier

- With such a diversity of classification methods, how do we decide which is best?
 - When our test distribution is the same as our training distribution?
 - When our test data are different?
 - When we need interpretable results?